

A Big Storm Called Isaias Is Heading for the U.S. Gulf Coast

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A **tropical storm** named Isaias formed on Wednesday in warm ocean water near eastern Mexico. **Forecasters** think it will quickly get stronger and become a **hurricane**. It is expected to reach the U.S. Gulf Coast late Friday or early Saturday, but its path could still change.

Michael Brennan leads the U.S. National **Hurricane** Center. He said Isaias could become a major Category 3 **hurricane**, which means very strong winds. **Forecasters** also warned about ocean water being pushed onto land and heavy rain that could cause flooding near the coast.

People are getting ready. The governors of Florida and Alabama **declared** emergencies for dozens of counties. A big shrimp festival in Gulf Shores, Alabama, was canceled. A college football game between Georgia and Alabama on Saturday might also be affected.

This **hurricane** season has been unusually quiet. If Isaias becomes a **hurricane**, it could tie or break a **record** from 1905 for the latest first **hurricane** of the Atlantic season.

Word Treasure

tropical storm -- A strong storm with heavy rain and wind that forms over warm ocean water.

Forecasters -- People who study the weather and tell us what it will probably do.

hurricane -- A huge, powerful storm with very strong winds that forms over the ocean.

declared -- Said something officially.

record -- The best or most extreme result that has ever been measured.

Background you need

A hurricane is a giant storm that forms over warm ocean water and has very strong, spinning winds.

Weather scientists watch these storms closely so people have time to get ready and stay safe.

Break it down

WHO: Forecasters, including Michael Brennan of the U.S. National Hurricane Center, and the governors of Florida and Alabama

WHAT: Tropical Storm Isaias is expected to become a hurricane and reach land late Friday or early Saturday

WHERE: The U.S. Gulf Coast, after forming in warm ocean water near eastern Mexico

WHY: Warnings and emergency plans help people get ready for strong winds, heavy rain and flooding

Why it matters

Knowing a storm is coming helps families make a plan, pack supplies and stay safe.

Test what you remember

1. What is the name of the storm?

- ☐ (A) Simon
- ☐ (B) Camille
- ☐ (C) Isaias
- ☐ (D) Polo

2. Where did the storm form?

- ☐ (A) Over the North Pole
- ☐ (B) In warm ocean water near eastern Mexico
- ☐ (C) In a lake in Texas
- ☐ (D) Near Alaska

3. When is the storm expected to reach the U.S. Gulf Coast?

- ☐ (A) Late Friday or early Saturday
- ☐ (B) In one month
- ☐ (C) Today at noon
- ☐ (D) Next year

4. Which festival was canceled?

- ☐ (A) A kite festival
- ☐ (B) A pumpkin festival
- ☐ (C) A music festival in New York
- ☐ (D) A big shrimp festival in Gulf Shores, Alabama

5. Which two states' governors declared emergencies?

- ☐ (A) Georgia and Maine
- ☐ (B) Florida and Alabama
- ☐ (C) California and Oregon
- ☐ (D) Texas and Ohio

6. What record could Isaias tie or break?

- ☐ (A) The coldest day ever
- ☐ (B) The latest first hurricane of the Atlantic season
- ☐ (C) The most snow in a year
- ☐ (D) The biggest wave ever

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: B 3: A 4: D 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

- 1. Michael Brennan, U.S. National Hurricane Center: Says Isaias could become a major Category 3 hurricane.**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):